



PIRANHA FISH
 These vicious fish live in the rivers of the rain forest. They have razor-sharp teeth and, when hundreds of them attack together, can kill and strip a large animal in minutes.

AMAZON

The Amazon River starts life in the Andes Mountains of Peru and flows for 4,001 miles (6,439 km) across South America until it gushes into the Atlantic Ocean. For more than half of its length, the Amazon flows through Brazil. It is the country's most important waterway, and large boats can travel inland as far as the modern city of Manaus, about 994 miles (1,600 km) from the sea. Every year the river floods and deposits fertile silt on the land.

The Amazon and its tributaries, swamps, and lakes form a vast network of freshwater.

Porto Alegre

Jan 77°F (25°C)
 July 57°F (14°C)
 Jan 3.5 in (89 mm)
 July 4.5 in (114 mm)



FUN IN THE SUN

Brazil's eastern coastline stretches 4,598 miles (7,400 km) along the Atlantic Ocean. In Rio de Janeiro, local people and tourists flock to the wide, sandy beaches to meet friends and play volleyball. The most popular beach in Rio de Janeiro is Copacabana, which is overlooked by Sugarloaf Mountain. Only good swimmers brave the waves though, because of strong currents.